Talha Khan

Senior Game Developer - Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Unity/C# engineer with 9+ years of experience and 30+ published mobile titles. Own complete game engineering from gameplay and architecture to optimization, LiveOps and Android/iOS delivery. Hands-on technical leader experienced in F2P economies, online services and growing development teams. Selected public games exceed 100M combined store-listing downloads.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ajax Studios Lahore, Pakistan — Aug 2019 - Present

Technical Team Lead | Progressed through Junior, Senior and Dev Lead roles

- **Grew engineering from one developer to eight** through hiring, training and mentoring; led architecture, code review and delivery while remaining hands-on.
- **Built Balanstein from scratch** and own its engineering through active, unreleased production: 2.5D physics gameplay, deterministic replay, progression and F2P economies.
- **Designed modular Unity/C# systems** using SOLID, dependency injection and reusable patterns; developed custom editor tools supporting approximately 800 levels.
- **Built online services** for player authentication, account linking and cloud saves; built and tested Local, Weekly and Global leaderboards.
- **Delivered UI for 28 languages,** including Arabic RTL, across mobile aspect ratios; collaborated with technical artists on VFX and character animation.
- **Profiled CPU/GPU performance,** memory, garbage collection and rendering against a 30-60 FPS target on 3 GB RAM devices to guide optimization.
- **Integrated monetization and LiveOps** with ad mediation, IAP, attribution, analytics, Remote Config, Firebase services and local/push notifications.
- **Delivered Android/iOS builds** and store releases with internal, alpha and closed testing, automated Unity tests and CI/CD; introduced reviewed AI-assisted CLI/MCP workflows.

ZEKAB International Limited Rawalpindi, Pakistan — May 2018 - Jun 2019

Game Developer

- **Shipped 16 Unity titles in 13 months,** owning gameplay, progression, IAP, ads, leaderboards and achievements through Google Play release.
- **Helped establish Unity workflows** and mentored junior developers and interns, collaborating on production and release quality.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Desire Studios Rawalpindi, Pakistan — Jul 2017 - Apr 2018
Game Developer | Promoted from Intern

- **Developed and published 18 mobile titles** across hyper-casual, simulation and puzzle genres, owning concept-to-deployment engineering and device optimization.
- **Employee of the Month five consecutive times** for the lowest crash rates in my games and creative ideas.
- **Refactored and optimized 23 additional studio games** to reduce crashes and fatal errors, working with designers and artists on production quality.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Unity & Gameplay
Unity 2D/3D, C#, ScriptableObjects, custom controllers, Input System/EnhancedTouch, Blend Trees, pooling, Unity Splines/Mathematics, save/load, Netcode

Software Engineering
OOP, SOLID, clean architecture, patterns, data structures/algorithms, async/await, dependency injection, cancellation, refactoring, code review

Graphics & Animation
URP/HDRP, Shader Graph, HLSL shaders, particles, post-processing, VFX, character animation, technical-artist collaboration

UI & Localization
uGUI, pixel-perfect animated UI, Canvas/Sprite Atlas optimization, aspect ratios, localization, Arabic RTL, virtualized lists

Profiling & Diagnostics
Unity Profiler, CPU/GPU/device profiling, frame time/FPS, memory, GC/draw-call reduction, Android logcat, device debugging

Testing & QA
Unity Test Framework, automated tests, internal/alpha/closed testing, cross-platform/device validation, bug tracking, pre-release QA

LiveOps & Backend
UGS Auth/Cloud Save/Cloud Code/Leaderboards/Analytics/Remote Config; Firebase Auth/Firestore/FCM/Analytics/Remote Config; REST, Unity Mobile Notifications

F2P & Game Economies
Economy design, resource sinks, progression, retention, replayability, adaptive difficulty, game business models, monetization analytics, A/B testing

Monetization & Attribution
AppLovin MAX, AdMob, Unity Ads, ad mediation, SDK integration, in-app purchases, AppsFlyer, Adjust

Release Pipeline & DevOps
Android/iOS, Play/App Store, IL2CPP/ARM64, Xcode, Android Studio, CI/CD, Unity Cloud Build, Git, Addressables, Asset Bundles, IMGUI/UI Toolkit editors

Supporting Languages & AI
C++, Python, Java, JavaScript; Claude Code, Unity MCP, Cursor, Codex; reviewed AI-assisted CLI/MCP implementation

Leadership & Production
Hiring, mentoring, technical guidance, Agile/sprint planning, code review, collaboration with designers, artists and QA

EDUCATION

Riphah International University — 2013 - 2017
BS (Hons) Software Engineering | Islamabad, Pakistan

GENRES & GAME MODELS

Vehicle simulation / Physics arcade / Hyper-casual / Puzzle / Action & shooter / Free-to-play / Live service